

1. Welcome and working hours

This handbook applies to all employees of Acme Ltd from 1 January 2026.

The standard working week is 40 hours, Monday to Friday. Core hours are 10:00 to 15:00 in your local time zone; outside core hours you may plan your day with your manager.

Questions about this handbook go to the People team at people@acme.example.

2. Annual leave

Full-time employees accrue 1.75 days of paid annual leave per month, which is 21 days a year. Part-time employees accrue leave pro rata to their contracted hours.

Up to 5 unused days carry over to the next year and must be taken by 31 March. Any other unused days lapse and are not paid out.

Requests longer than 3 consecutive working days need manager approval at least 2 weeks in advance through the HR portal. Shorter requests need 2 working days' notice.

3. Sick leave and parental leave

Employees receive up to 10 days of sick leave a year at full pay. A medical certificate is required for absences longer than 2 consecutive days.

Primary carers receive 16 weeks of parental leave at full pay. Secondary carers receive 4 weeks at full pay, to be taken within the first year.

4. Remote work

Employees may work remotely up to 3 days a week with their manager's agreement. Working from another country for more than 14 days in a year needs written approval from the People team.

Acme provides a one-off home office allowance of \$500, claimable within the first 3 months of employment.